

241 Plant a fruit tree

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MINS

Every wildlife-friendly yard needs a tree. A tree's leaves provide shelter for many creatures, while birds and small mammals may nest in its branches. Here's how to plant a tree in your yard.

You will need

- Small tree, such as a crab apple
- Shovel
- Watering can
- Rubber tree-tie
- Stake



1 Water the tree while it's still in the pot. Dig a hole twice as wide as the root ball and place the tree, still in the pot, in the hole.



2 Lay a stick across to check that the levels match. Remove the pot. Cover the roots with soil. Hammer in the stake at an angle, and tie it to the tree.



3 Water the tree regularly throughout its first year. Remove the stake when it is strong enough to stand by itself.

242 Grow an oak tree

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Put some acorns and damp sawdust in a sealed plastic bag in the refrigerator until roots appear. Plant an acorn 2–4 in (5–10 cm) deep in a pot. Once it's 4 in (10 cm) tall, plant it outdoors.

